

The Art of Healthy Aging

Ahmet G. GUNGOR

27th October 2025

Homework-2

Why Should We Live Healthily?

"More good years, not just more years"

Healthspan is the disease-free period of life.

The Goal must be reducing the risk of chronic disease and increase the quality of our life. For that;

- Our target is to stay healthy.
- We are not waiting for illness. We are taking preventions.
- We are taking small steps and we ensure continuity.

What happens if I don't? increased risk of chronic disease; decreased quality of life.

Cell-Focused Model

"Youth begins in the cell"

Our aim is to protect our mitochondria. Because mitochondria are the powerhouses of cells.

- In addition, we need to support NAD and sirtuins. Because NAD is a helper molecule for cell repair. Sirtuin is a repair protein for longevity.
- We do this like a lifestyle. Because, strengthening cellular energy and repair mechanisms slows down biological aging.

What should we do to increase NAD and Sirtunis?

Timing (When Do we Eat?)

"My timing is my most powerful nutrient."

Our main goal is to lower blood sugar and initiate the cell repair process.

Autophagy is the cell's cleaning-repair process.

The necessary actions to achieve this are listed below.

- Eat 2 meals a day. The first meal should be between 11:00 am - 1:00 pm. No snacking until the evening meal. Fluids can be allowed.
- The evening meal should be early, by 5:00-6:00 pm. And no solid food should be eaten afterwards, not even a morsel. Fluids can be allowed.
- This way, your digestive system rests for 17 hours a day. This means our metabolism eliminates harmful cells. Additionally, we will improve our sleep quality.

What Should We Eat?

"You are what you eat"

- We should eat natural and simple foods.
- Vegetables are fibrous foods, we should eat them. Because fibers provide a feeling of fullness while supporting beneficial bacteria (microbiota).
- We should choose healthy fats and quality proteins. For example, we should use only butter and olive oil. For protein, we should prefer lamb, sea fish, and free-range chicken.
- We should drink 2-3 liters of water per day. Tea, coffee, etc., do not replace water. We should not drink water 30 minutes before and after meals. Because it reduces stomach acid and makes digestion difficult.

What Am I Reducing?

"Excess of anything is harmful; man digs his grave with his teeth" (*Hüseyin GÜNGÖR*)

- Glycation is the process where sugar binds to proteins and causes damage. To prevent this damage;
- Reduce sugar.
- Quit white flour.
- Avoid of processed foods.
- Do not use milk and dairy products.

What happens if we don't? Glycation increases; liver fat and weight gain accelerate.

Sleep and Rhythm

"Sleep is a short journey to reality."

- The circadian rhythm is the 24-hour biological clock. Melatonin is the most important hormone regulating night sleep.

Important points for our sleep routine are given below.

- Sleep at the same time every day. The most ideal time to start sleeping is between 10:00-11:00 pm. Avoid looking at screens (TV, phone, etc.) 1-2 hours before sleep. Reading a book in dim light is recommended.
- The bedroom should be completely dark and not very hot. Use a sleep mask if you need.

Movement

"Movement is the cheapest medicine."

- We should try to 30 minutes walk every day.
- We should do weight training or reformer pilates 2-3 times a week.
- We should not sit for long periods; we should get up and walk frequently

What happens if I don't? Muscle and bone loss begins; metabolism slows down.

"If you keep your muscles strong until your 30s, you will be comfortable in your 60s."

Stress and Environment

"When the mind calms down, the body rejuvenates"

Toxic load is the total amount of harmful chemicals entering the body. These are cigarettes, excessive alcohol, heavy metals, pesticides. We can be exposed to these effects during the day, whether we want to or not. Therefore;

- Do breathing and relaxation exercises.
- Go out into nature and practice mindfulness.
- Strength social bonds.

What happens if I don't? Sleep is disrupted; decision-making quality decreases.

Sample Daily Plan

"Routine is the autopilot of willpower."

The goal is to build sustainable habits.

- Drink water in the morning and take a short walk.
- Eat fiber and healthy protein at noon.
- Finish the dinner early.
- Take movement breaks during the day.
- Reduce screen time at night and «At 10 pm, fly and perch in bed😊»

Measure

"You can't manage what you don't measure."

Waist size shows belly fat. The general target is less than 94 cm for men and 80 cm for women. For motivation;

- Measure your waist circumference and take notes.
- Schedule a blood test if necessary.
- Small progress should be noted.

What happens if I don't? Motivation may be lost.

Summary

"Small steps increase length of your life"

- We eat meals at timed intervals.
- We reduce sugar, flour, and dairy products.
- We should sleep well and move regularly.
- Manage your stress and return to nature.
- It is better to take small but continuous steps.

Thank you

"Aging will be accepted as a disease by the World Health Organization within 5 years."
(Dr.Ayşegül Çoruhlu)